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500 Attend African Liberation Day At Learning Center

PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF ANGOLA

U.N. AMBASSADOR: "WE KNOW

WHAT IT IS TO BE FREE"

JUN 14 1976

UNIV. OF VIRGINIA
CHARLOTTESVILLE, VA.



The May 29 African Liberation Day celebration at the Oakland Community Learning Center was a huge success. Honored guests were ELISIO DEFIGUEREDO (top left) of Angola, HAMZA AZIZ (top right) of Tanzania, and (bottom row, left to right) RUEBEN HWANGA of SWAPO in Namibia, MOGALE MOKGOATSANE of the PAC in Azania and MICHAEL MAWEMA of ZANU in Zimbabwe.

(Oakland, Calif.) - In a joyful nine-hour celebration, over 500 Bay Area activists and progressive-minded community people joined with representatives of the liberation movements in southern Africa to celebrate African Liberation Day last Saturday, May 29, at the Oakland Community Learning Center.

The highlight of the memorable day-long event was the appearance and keynote address delivered by Elisio Defigueiredo, ambassador designate to the United Nations from the newly established People's Republic of Angola. Ambassador Defigueiredo, who received a standing ovation and wildly enthusiastic applause upon his entry into the auditorium of the Learning Center, told the predominantly Black audience that, "Every man, woman and child in Angola knows today what it is to be free. . . Angola has rid itself of the disease of imperialism and colonialism and stands ever vigilant to prevent a recurrence. . ." (See page 17 for the complete text of Ambassador Defigueiredo's speech.)

Joining the esteemed Angolan ambassador as honored guests at the African Liberation Day ceremonies were Hamza Aziz, consul from the Tanzanian embassy in the U.S.; Michael Mawema, national organizing secretary of the Zimbabwe African National Union (ZANU); Mogale Mokgoatsane, a representative of the Pan Africanist Congress (PAC) of Azania (South Africa) and Rueben Hwanga, a representative of the South West People's Organization (SWAPO) of Namibia.

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